ONE MODEL. SIMULATE. FIT. OPTIMIZE.

Hands-On with Rumoca

James Goppert
Managing Director, PURT · Research Assistant Professor

Micah Condie
PhD student · School of Aeronautics and Astronautics

Purdue University · Georgia Tech · 10:00–13:00



MODEL
Declare the physics

FIT
Learn from data

OPTIMIZE
Plan the motion

CREATE CORE CODESPACE

Any modeling domain welcome · no aerospace background needed

Scan to create the core Codespace · materials linked below

Repository ↗ **Workshop guide ↗** **Create Codespace ↗**

Run the core. Explore your own question.

YOUR QUESTION. YOUR EXPERIMENT.

Make something you care about.

Experiment in a model or simulator.

Core: edit a model, fit data, optimize a trajectory

One change in an existing model or simulator is enough

THE PRIZE

FREE

CogniPilot stocking cap

Short demos
Audience hand vote

Enter by 12:40 · up to 5 demos · CHALLENGE.md · hosting optional

Challenge rules ↗ **Example prompts ↗**

Why Rumoca? One model, many questions.

A unified, declarative foundation for cyberphysical systems.

Lie group theory

Represent rotations and motion with their geometric structure.

Reachable sets

Bound possible behavior of cyberphysical systems under uncertainty.

Formal software verification

Connect model equations to explicit proof obligations.

System identification + digital twins

Fit physical parameters; compare simulation with experiments.

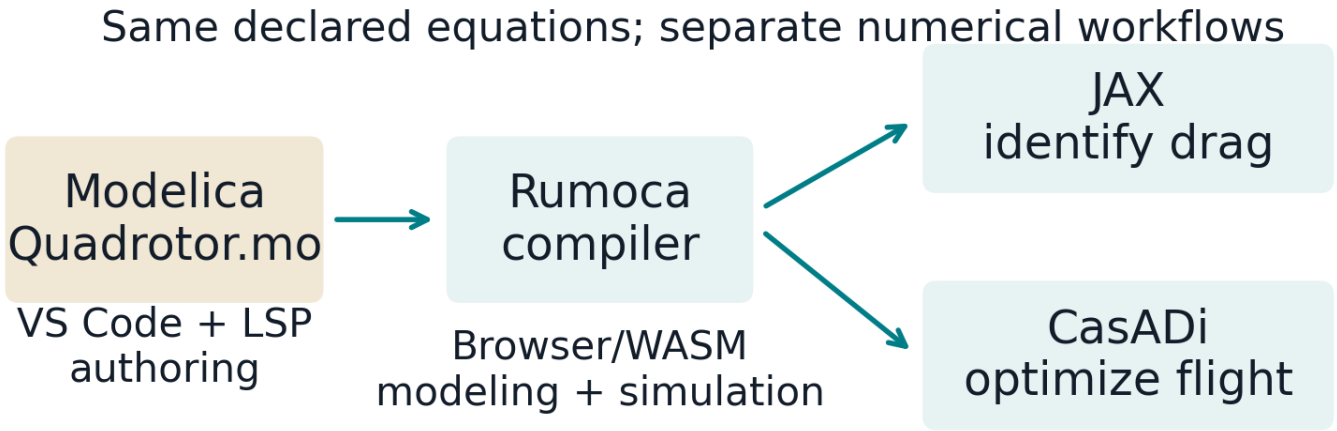
Cerebri RDD2: Modelica → eFMI C → Zephyr RTOS → real drone

Goal: mathematical guarantees for specified properties under explicit assumptions.

Rumoca compiler ↗ | Model library ↗ | Cerebri RDD2 ↗

Declare once. Ask different questions.

Quadrotor.mo → JAX + CasADi · the same declared equations





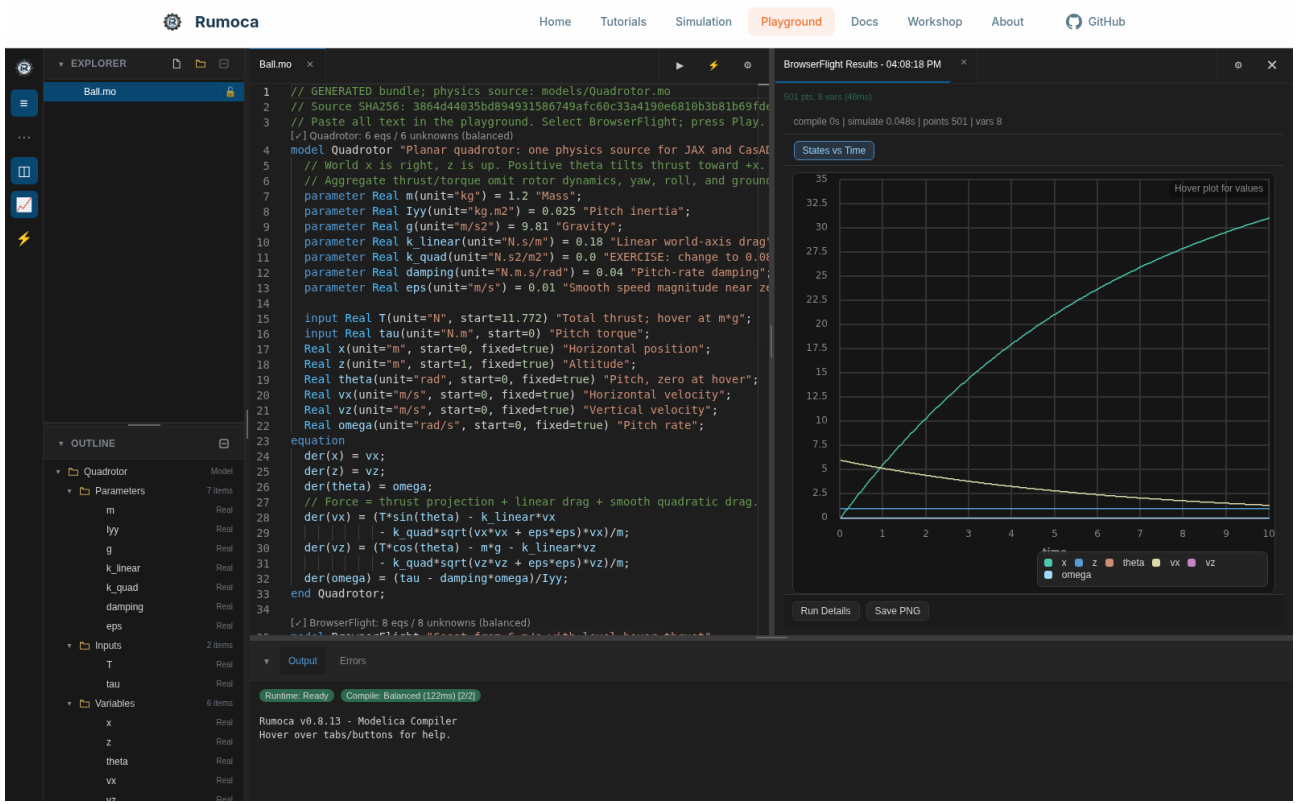
Digital twins →
measured flight at PURT

Modelica declares physics · Rumoca compiles · backends compute.

Everyone gets a browser plot

TRY THIS

1. Open the playground
2. Paste the complete browser bundle
3. Gear → BrowserFlight → Play



You should see BrowserFlight Results and a plot.

Open playground ↗

Browser model ↗

Choose a full-workshop route

01 Local container: Docker + Reopen in Container

02 Codespaces: same container; login and allowance

03 Local uv: optional native installation

04 Browser or pair: keep working during setup

Switch route after ten minutes of setup trouble.

Local VS Code setup ↗ | Create Codespace ↗ | Recovery help ↗

Configure the experiment, then run it

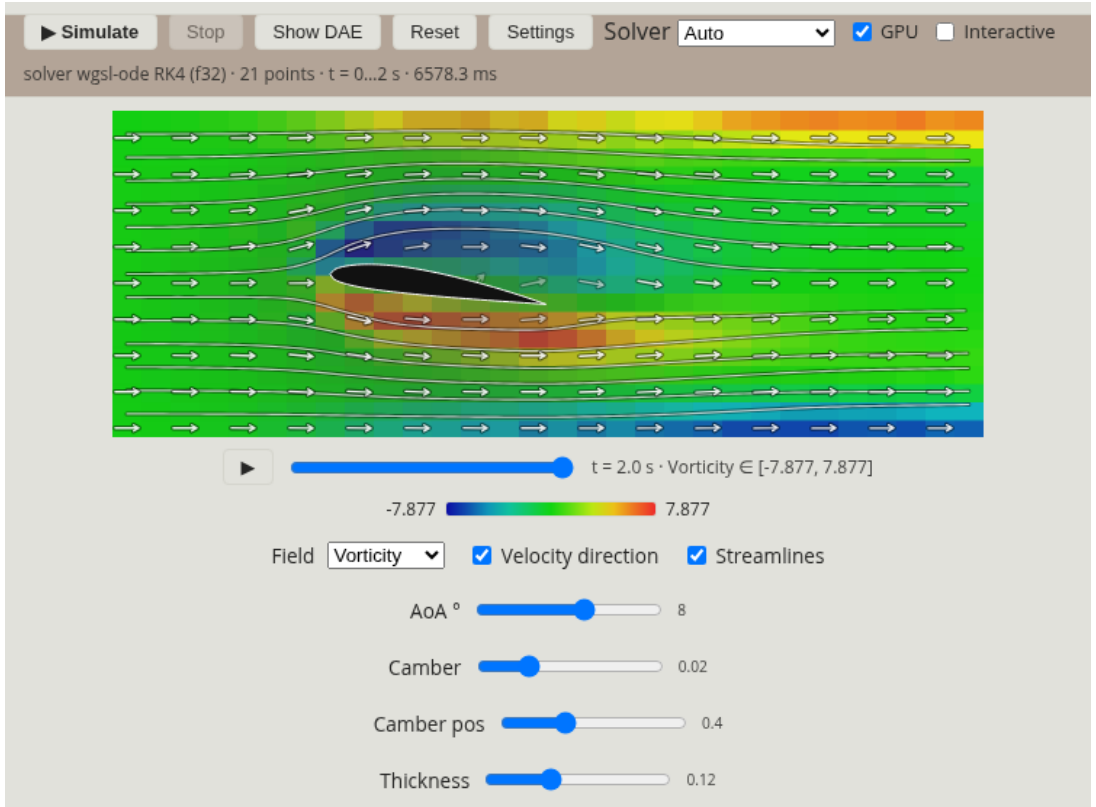
1. Open BrowserFlight.mo → click the lightning bolt
2. Save scenario TOML → model, source roots, solver, end time
3. Run the scenario → inspect vx and x

Modelica owns physics · TOML owns the run configuration.

The user guide is a live modeling lab

TRY THIS

1. Edit StopTime: 30 → 2 s
2. Simulate; select the final frame
3. Switch vorticity / pressure



User-guide link and recovery: WORKSHOP.md · no install needed

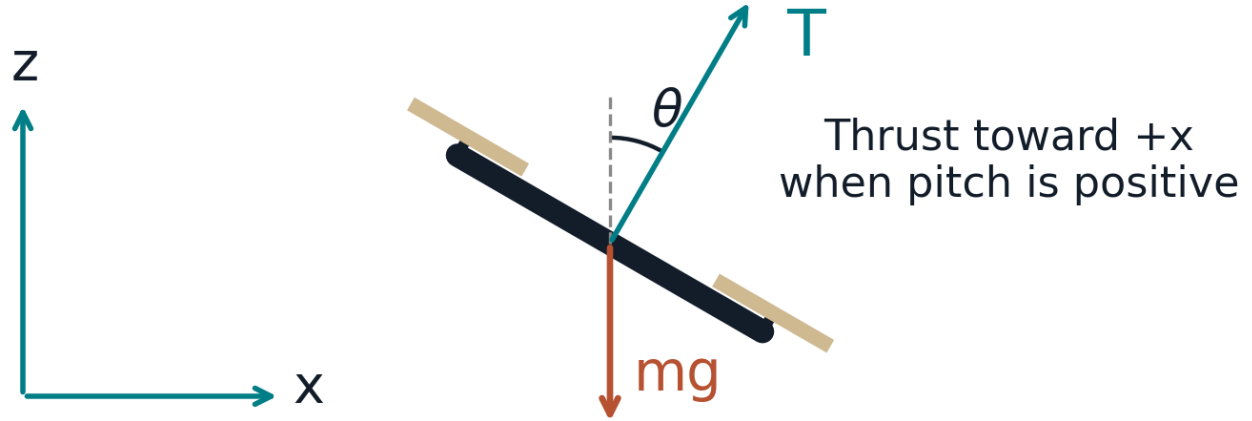
Open NACA example ↗ **Explore user guide ↗**

A planar quadrotor we can inspect

READ THE MODEL

1. World x right; z up
2. Positive pitch tilts thrust toward +x
3. Hover: T = mg = 11.772 N

Planar motion; ideal aggregate thrust and torque



Find velocities, pitch rate, thrust and torque in the model.

Open vehicle model ↗

Workshop guide ↗

Your first engineering change: drag

Change k_quad = 0.0 to 0.08, save, then simulate.

$$D(v) = -k_{\text{linear}} v - k_{\text{quad}} \sqrt{v^2 + \varepsilon^2}\, v$$

Linear: N s/m Quadratic: N s²/m² ε = 0.01 m/s

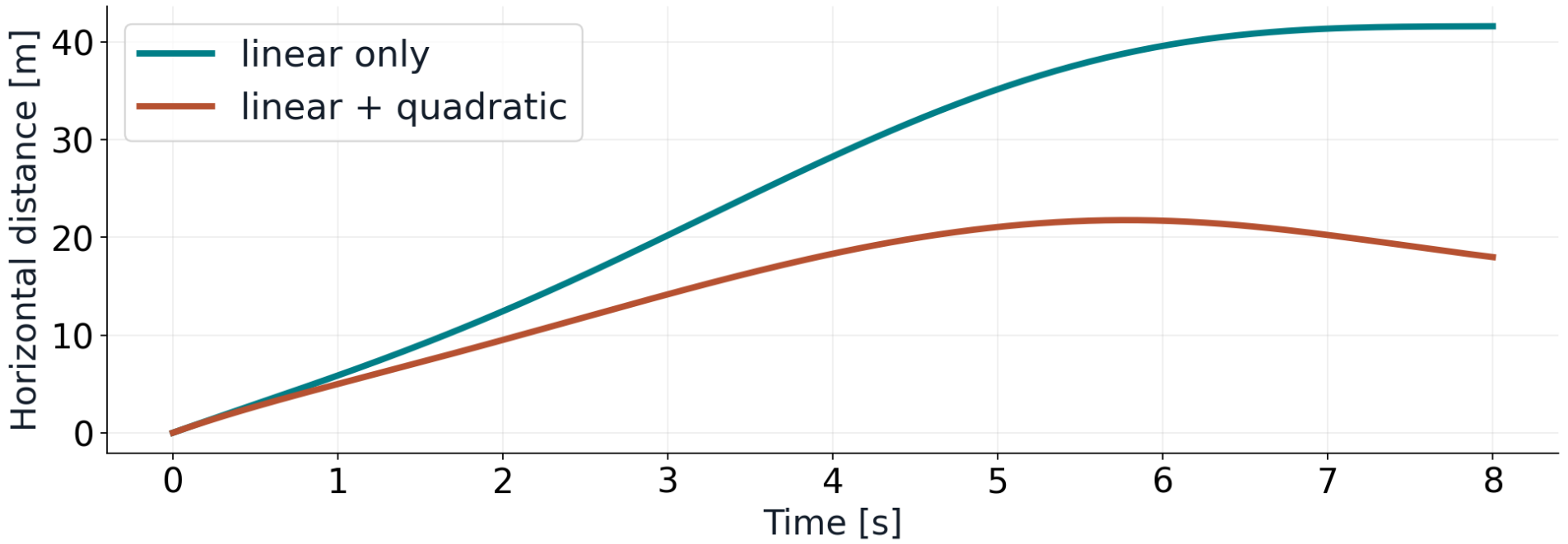
Nonnegative coefficients ⇒ drag opposes motion

```
$ uv run --frozen python examples/simulate.py
```

What changes at high speed? What about negative velocity?

More drag, less distance

Reference at 8 s: 41.60 m → 17.97 m



Compare your current default with the two reference cases.

Back at

11:10

10 MINUTES

Stretch. Ask a question. Keep your editor open.

KEEP YOUR PLACE

Keep your editor and terminal open.

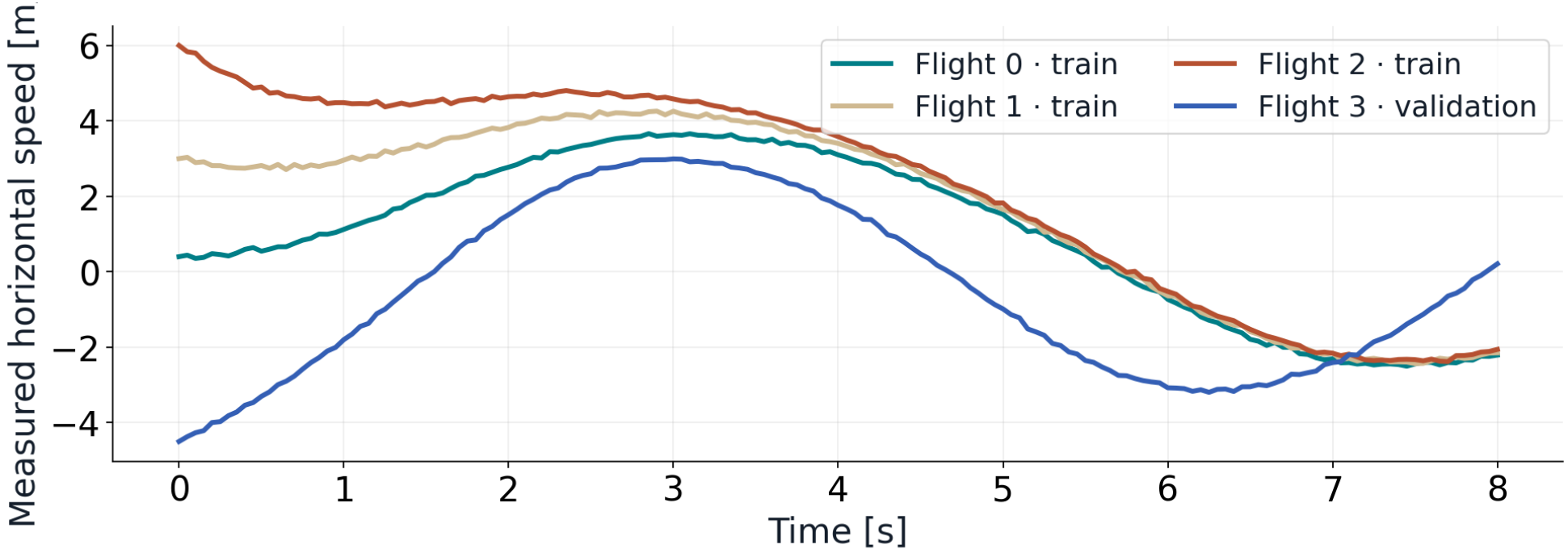
Your simulation plot is the recovery point.

Next: learn drag from noisy data.

Worksheet and commands: WORKSHOP.md · scan the opening QR.

Known experiment. Unknown coefficients.

Three training flights; one held-out flight. 20 Hz, 8 s each.



Speed variation helps separate linear and quadratic drag.

Differentiate the prediction error

Positive parameters; noise-scaled loss; bounded optimization

Generated RHS Modelica → JAX → RK4 rollout positive drag → Data residuals scaled by noise → JAX gradients L-BFGS-B

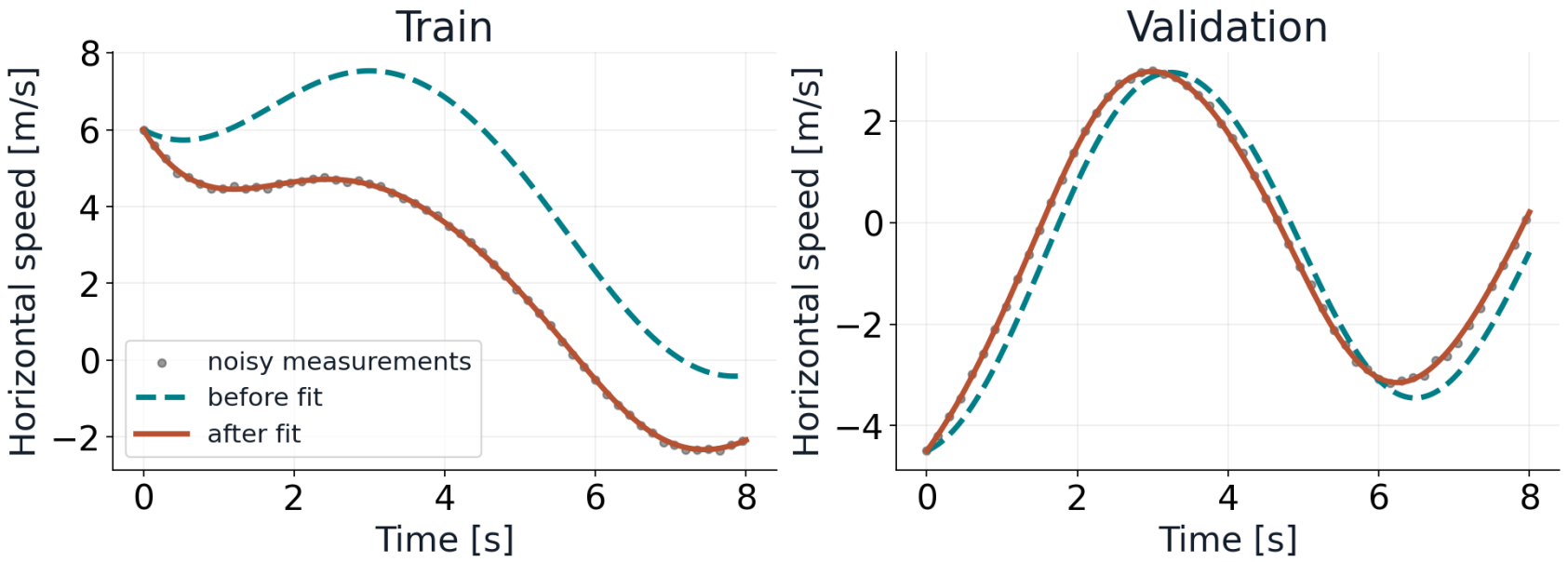
$$L = \mathrm{mean}\left[\left(\frac{\hat{y} - y}{\sigma}\right)^2\right]$$

$$k_l / k_{l,\mathrm{ref}} = e^a, \quad k_q / k_{q,\mathrm{ref}} = e^b$$

JAX provides gradients. SciPy updates the coefficients.

Run the fit. Test the held-out flight.

Open fit_drag.png and fit_drag.json; compare before and after.




```
$ uv run --frozen python examples/fit_drag_jax.py
```

Two coefficients · lower loss · improved held-out prediction

Check your result. Keep building.

01 Open your before-and-after prediction plot

02 Compare the held-out flight and fitted values

03 Stretch: rerun from another starting guess

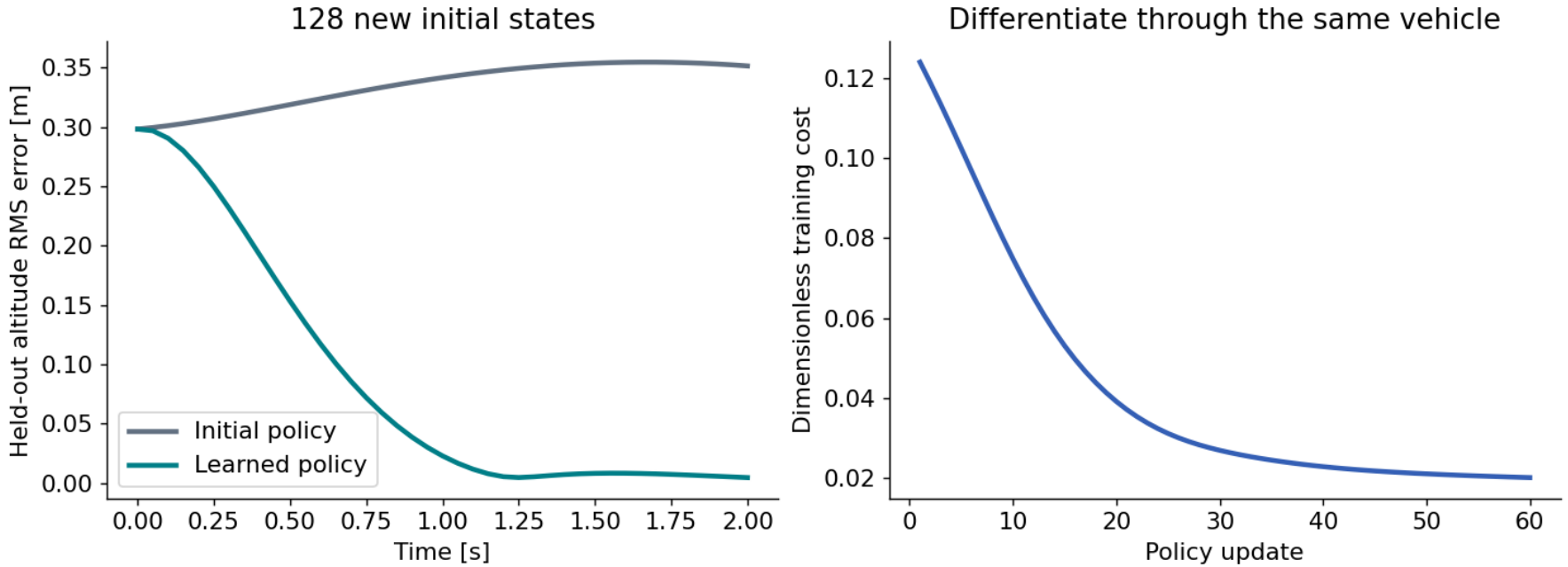
04 App builders: keep your prototype moving

Fit complete? Continue your experiment or explore the optional checks.

Workshop guide ↗

Make a target. Learn a policy.

target.toml → generated Torch → differentiable policy learning




```
$ uv run --frozen --group torch python scripts/learn_hover_torch.py
```

Held-out cost ≈ 0.116 → 0.021 · optional instructions: BACKENDS.md

Backend walkthrough ↗ | Torch target.toml ↗ | Lean Jinja target ↗

Back at

12:10

10 MINUTES

Stretch. Ask a question. Keep your editor open.

KEEP YOUR PLACE

Keep your fitted coefficients.

Next: plan a flight using your fit.

Your fit plot is the recovery point.

Same Modelica source; now compile to CasADi.

Move between hovers, respect limits

THE IDEA

1. (0, 1) m → (4, 2) m in 6 s
2. Track target; limit effort and control changes
3. Bound thrust, torque, pitch and altitude



T: 0–20 N τ: ±0.35 N m

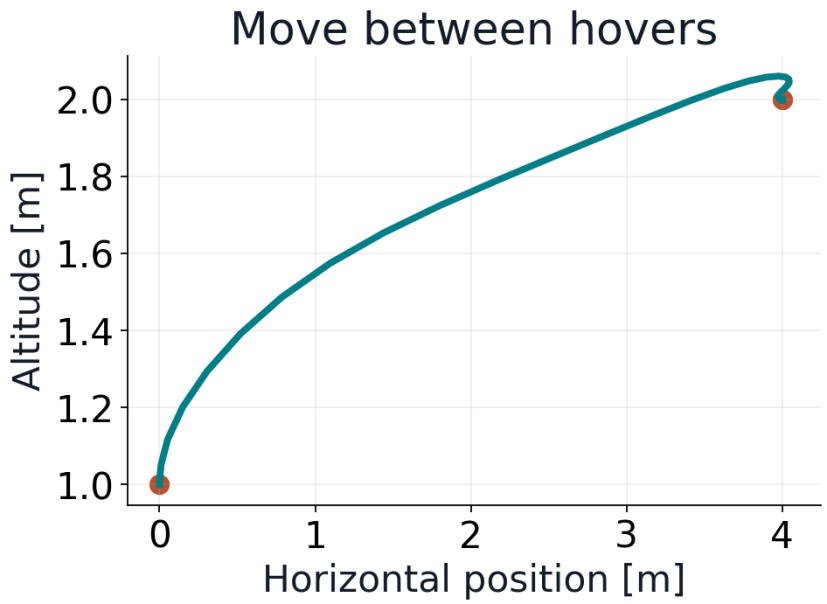
z: 0.25–4 m |θ| ≤ 0.55 rad

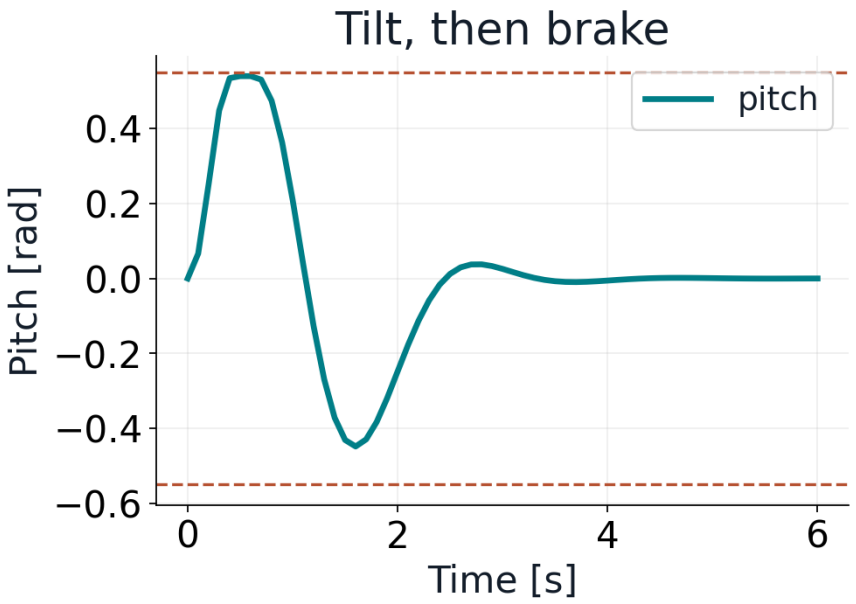
60 shooting intervals · node pitch margin · independent reintegration

Identified drag is an input to this optimization.

Solve. Inspect. Explain the braking.

Open optimization.png and optimization.json.





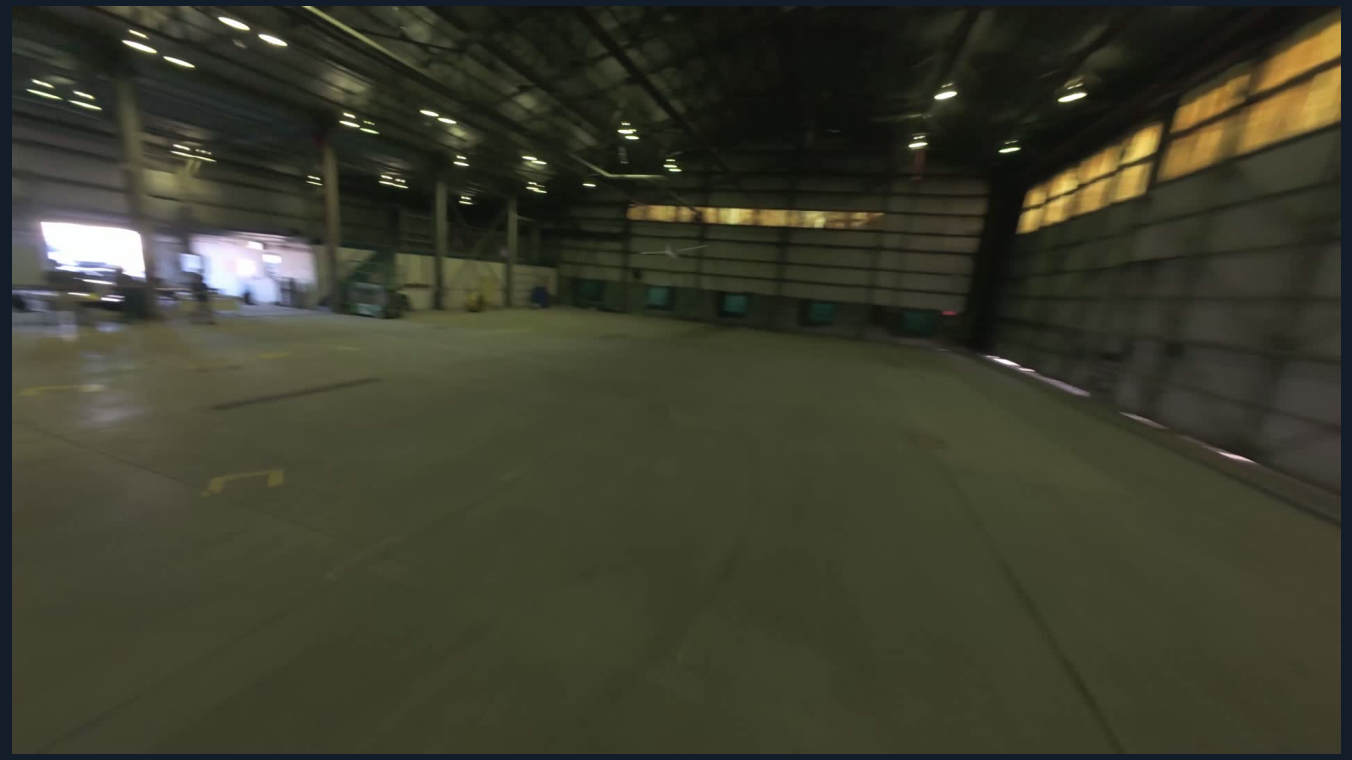

```
$ uv run --frozen python examples/optimize_casadi.py
```

Solve_Succeeded · limits respected · arrive near rest

Workshop guide ↗

Next up: pylon racing at PURT

The next competition will leverage Rumoca



PURT FPV chase · September 2025 · click video to play

FOLLOW THE NEXT COMPETITION

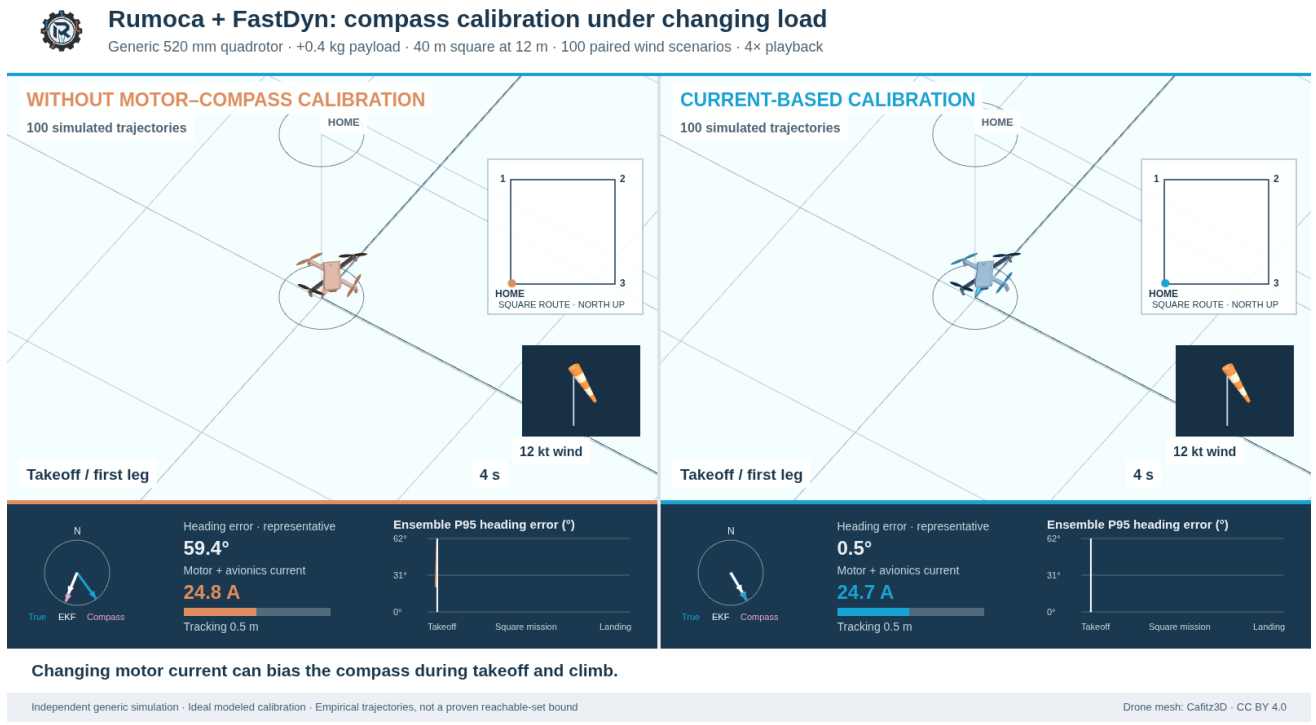
pylon-racing.geddes.rcac.purdue.edu

PURT pylon racing ↗ | **Watch race video ↗** | **Challenge rules ↗**

FastDyn: fly the firmware against declared physics

PHYSICS + ACTUAL FIRMWARE

1. Modelica → Rumoca FMI 3 plant
2. ArduPilot firmware → FastDyn / QEMU
3. Recorded: 100 paired wind scenarios
4. Try: 3 load trials in a FastDyn Codespace



Recorded research demo · separate from today's 3 trials

```
$ uv run --frozen python scripts/fastdyn_demo.py
```

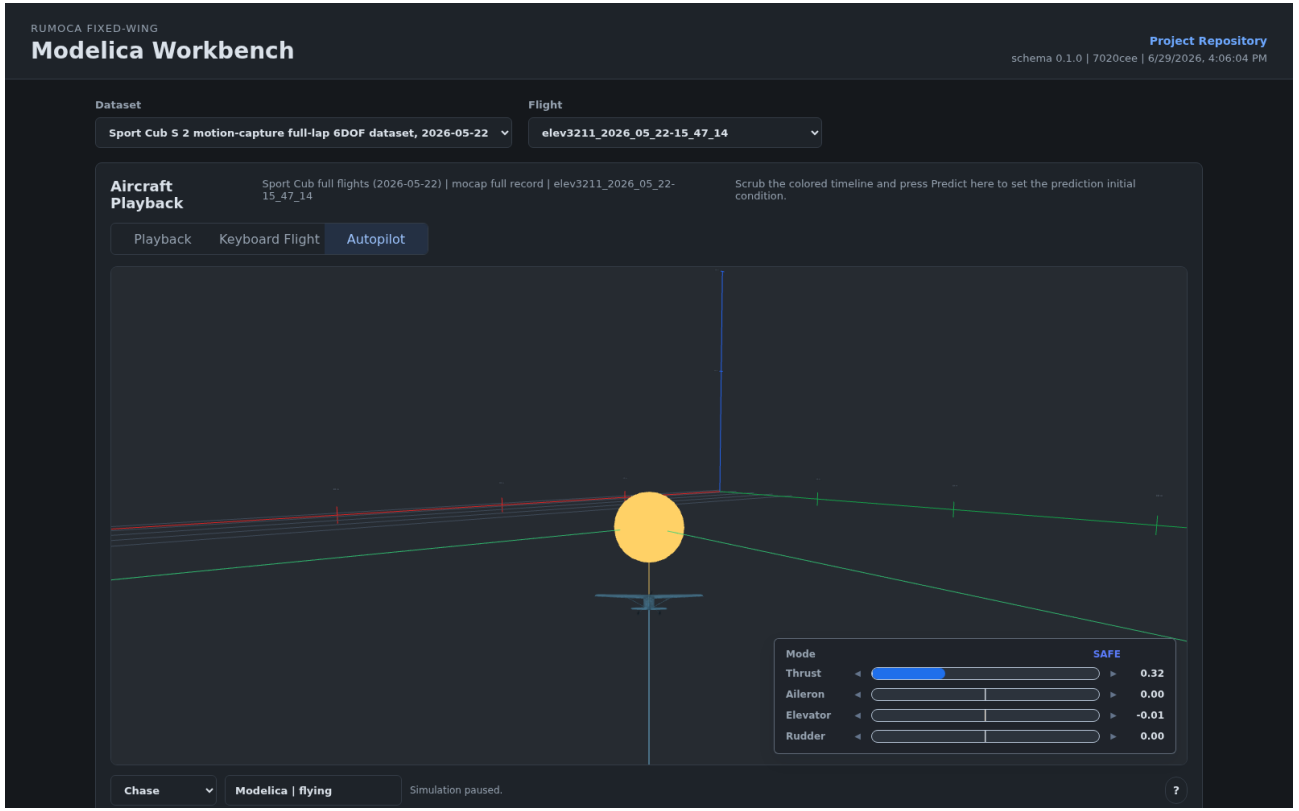
Choose the FastDyn container · open results/live/fastdyn/trajectories.png

FastDyn demo guide ↗ | BoardRunner paper ↗ | FastDyn source ↗ | Recorded Monte Carlo ↗

Explore the fixed-wing workbench

TRY THIS

1. Modelica flight simulation + autopilot
2. Try 50 Hz → 20 Hz, restart, then observe
3. Change a setting. Check what changes.



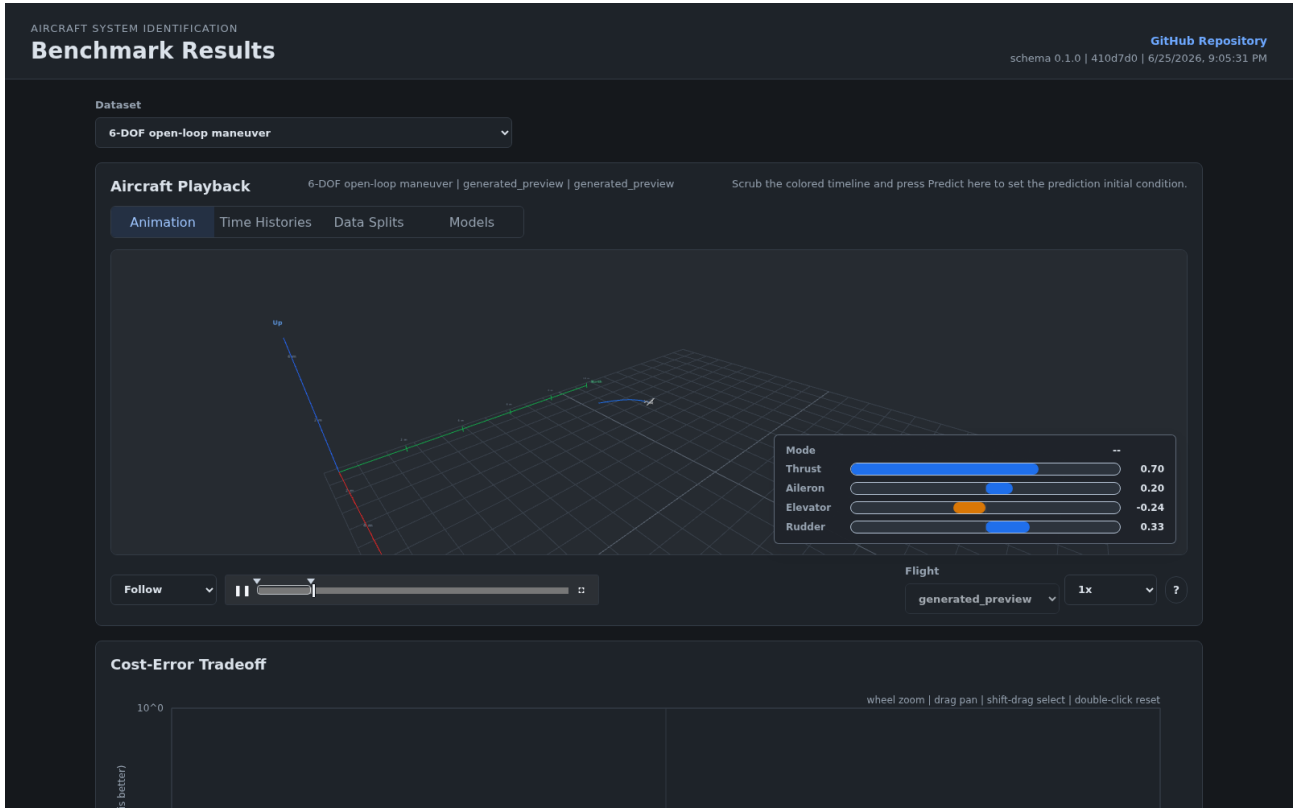
Live links + short experiments: BROWSER_APPS.md

Try fixed-wing ↗ | **Source code ↗** | **Experiment guide ↗**

Explore motion-capture identification

TRY THIS

1. Visualize vehicle data and model structure
2. Compare experiments and data splits
3. A viewer for exported benchmark results



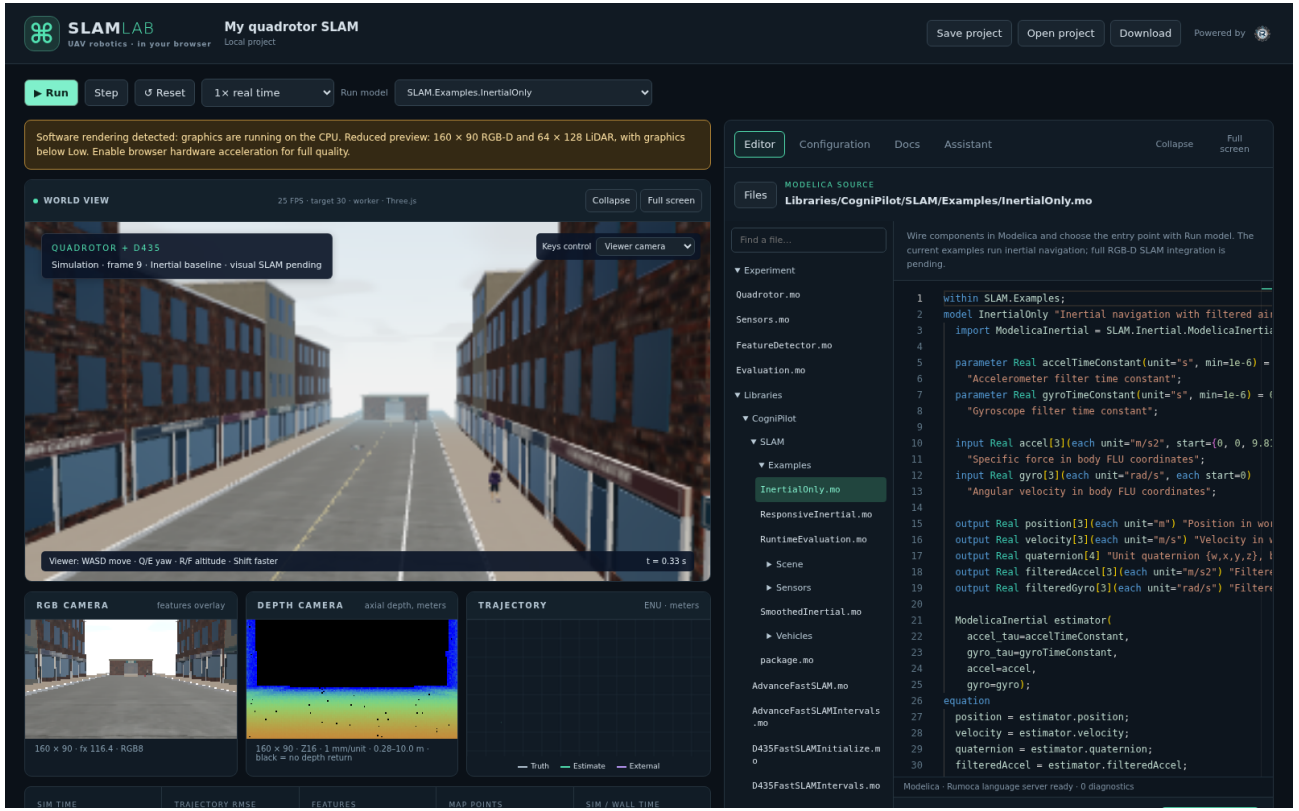
Explore exported identification results.

Try the app ↗ **Source code ↗** **Experiment guide ↗**

Explore SLAM Lab · in development

TRY THIS

1. Try the inertial estimation baseline
2. Inspect RGB, depth and trajectories
3. Visual SLAM and loop closure are in development



Start with the tested inertial baseline.

Try the app ↗ | Source code ↗ | Experiment guide ↗

Show your experiment. Vote for the cap.

5	45 s	1
MAX. PRESENTERS	EACH DEMO	VOTE PER PERSON

Show your change + one checked result

Name your tool. Share elapsed work time.

Audience favorite wins a free CogniPilot stocking cap

Random draw if more than 5 ready entries → audience hand vote

Challenge rules ↗ Optional gallery ↗

Bring your model.
Join the work.

1. Bring a model or a question from your own domain
2. Add a validation case, model library or compiler fix
3. Start a conversation: problem + model + one check

James Goppert · Micah Condie

Scan to join the work · COMMUNITY.md · questions welcome

Join the community ↗ **Rumoca compiler ↗** **Model library ↗**